NEXATECH Student Monitor Go Live Expense Budget

Approved launch package for one school

This budget assigns exact amounts for launching and operating NEXATECH Student Monitor for one school. The approved funding is US$425.40 for the first month and US$60.40 for each normal operating month after launch.

Fixed scope: one production system, no more than 1,000 total data subjects, one business mailbox, up to 3,000 transactional emails per month, and 500 SMS messages per month.

Approved Monthly Operating Expenses

Expense	Included service	Monthly USD
Production hosting	Railway application, worker, MySQL and Redis	$40.00
Business mailbox	One Google Workspace Business Starter mailbox	$8.40
Transactional email	Resend Free plan, maximum 3,000 emails per month	$0.00
SMS messaging	Prepaid allowance for 500 local SMS messages	$10.00
Database recovery	Backup and recovery storage allocation	$2.00
Uptime monitoring	Better Stack Free plan	$0.00
CAPTCHA protection	Cloudflare Turnstile Free plan	$0.00
SSL and DNS	Cloudflare and Railway certificates and DNS	$0.00
Monthly total	**Approved recurring operating budget**	**$60.40**

Launch and Annual Expenses

Expense	Frequency	Amount USD
Domain registration	Annual	$15.00
POTRAZ Tier 1 data controller licence	Annual	$50.00
Zimbabwe privacy and contract review	Launch only	$300.00
Launch expense total	**Due before public onboarding**	**$365.00**

Budget Totals

Budget period	Calculation	Total USD
First month cash requirement	$365.00 launch expenses plus $60.40 operations	$425.40
Months 2 through 12	$60.40 each month for 11 months	$664.40
First year total	Complete launch year	$1,089.80
Year 2 baseline	$724.80 operations plus $65 annual renewals	$789.80

Financial Rules

- **Hosting allocation:** Railway spending is limited to the approved $40.00 monthly infrastructure budget.
- **SMS limit:** The system may send no more than 500 prepaid SMS messages in a month without a new approval.
- **Payment fees:** Paynow transaction fees are added to the payer's transaction and are not charged to this operating budget.
- **Email limit:** Resend remains on the free plan and must stay within 3,000 emails per month and 100 emails per day.
- **Scope control:** A second school or more than 1,000 data subjects requires a new operating budget and licensing review.
- **No hidden contingency:** Spending above any line in this document requires written approval before purchase.

What This Budget Delivers

The approved package provides a custom domain, HTTPS, production hosting, a MySQL database, Redis queues, scheduled processing, one professional email inbox, transactional email, 500 monthly SMS messages, backups, monitoring, CAPTCHA protection, and launch compliance review. It does not include additional schools, paid advertising, custom mobile applications, staff devices, internet connectivity, or payment transaction charges.

Pricing Sources

1. **Railway.** Pro plan and usage-based infrastructure pricing. https://docs.railway.com/pricing/plans
2. **Google Workspace.** Business Starter flexible plan at $8.40 per user per month. https://knowledge.workspace.google.com/admin/billing/compare-flexible-and-annual-fixed-term-payment-plans
3. **Resend.** Free transactional email plan with 3,000 emails per month and a 100-email daily limit. https://resend.com/pricing
4. **SMSPoP Zimbabwe.** Prepaid package of 500 SMS credits for $10. https://www.smspop.co.zw/pricing
5. **Cloudflare.** At-cost domain registration, DNS and SSL services. https://developers.cloudflare.com/registrar/
6. **Better Stack.** Free uptime monitors and heartbeat monitoring. https://betterstack.com/uptime
7. **POTRAZ.** Tier 1 data controller licence fee of $50. https://www.potraz.gov.zw/wp-content/uploads/2025/02/SI-155-of-2024-Cyber-and-Data-Protection-Normal_240913_1250178.pdf
8. **Paynow.** Transaction fees can be added to the payer rather than absorbed by the platform. https://www.paynow.co.zw/Home/Fees